

Sandu Stefan | Cybersecurity & AI Student

Bucharest – Romania

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Professional Summary

Second-year Economic Cybernetics student at ASE Bucharest with a security-first approach to software engineering. Competed in two international hackathons in 2026: reverse-engineered a production flight-search API at VibeHack Bucharest (24 h) and built a privacy-preserving AI workspace with local-first data architecture at the AI Agent Olympics during Milan AI Week at Fiera Milano (7-day hybrid build). Combines quantitative training (statistics, econometrics, Python, C++) with hands-on experience in API security analysis, secure credential management, and privacy-by-design systems. Seeking internships in cybersecurity, penetration testing, or AI security where I can apply my builder mindset and analytical rigour.

Education

Academy of Economic Studies (ASE) <i>B.Sc. Economic Cybernetics, Statistics & Computer Science</i> Relevant coursework: Statistics, Mathematics, Econometrics, Databases, Programming Fundamentals, Data Security.	Bucharest 2024 – 2027 (<i>expected</i>)
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Technical Skills

Languages: Python (intermediate), C++, SQL, HTML/CSS, JavaScript/TypeScript (reading level)
Frameworks: FastAPI, Next.js (exposure), Electron (exposure)
Tools: Git/GitHub, Linux, Docker, Twilio API, Google Gemini API, OpenAI API, Firebase
Security: API reverse engineering & traffic analysis, secure credential management, privacy-by-design architecture, local-first data storage patterns
Design: Figma, Adobe After Effects, Premiere Pro, Photoshop, Illustrator

Hackathon Projects

AI Agent Olympics – Milan AI Week 2026 <i>PrivAI — Privacy-First AI Workspace</i> Built a desktop AI workspace for business automation with a team of 4 at Europe’s largest AI conference (\$32 000+ prize pool, hosted by lablab.ai). All chat data stays on-device in SQLite; Firebase handles only authentication. ○ Developed a privacy guard module that applies regex-based redaction to outbound prompts, preventing PII leakage to external LLM providers. ○ Built a FastAPI backend serving a Next.js/Electron frontend with SSE streaming, file tools, and terminal access for autonomous agent workflows. ○ Implemented local-first architecture: conversations, search caches, and redaction logs stored exclusively in on-device SQLite — zero chat data touches the cloud. ○ Integrated Google Gemini API with multi-model support (text + vision), orchestrated via an agentic pipeline with tool-calling, web search (SearXNG), and approval workflows. <i>Tech: Python, TypeScript, FastAPI, Next.js, Electron, Firebase Auth, SQLite, Gemini API</i>	Fiera Milano, Italy (in-person) 13–20 May 2026
VibeHack Bucharest – Vola.ro AI Challenge <i>JetSeeker — WhatsApp AI Travel Assistant</i>	Bucharest 14–15 Mar 2026

Built a WhatsApp-native AI travel assistant in 24 hours for Romania's largest online travel agency (vola.ro). The bot searches real flights, analyses booking screenshots, and identifies destinations from photos — all inside WhatsApp.

- **Reverse-engineered Vola.ro's production flight-search API:** intercepted network traffic, analysed request/response structures, session handling, and polling mechanisms to build a reliable data integration layer.
- Built an LLM function-calling pipeline (Qwen3-8B) that extracts IATA codes and dates from natural language, calls the flight API, and formats results conversationally.
- Integrated Twilio WhatsApp API with FastAPI, using background task processing to handle Twilio's webhook timeout constraints.
- Designed for **group chat dynamics:** selective response logic (reply only when tagged), multi-turn context management, and handling conflicting travel preferences from multiple users.

Tech: Python, FastAPI, Twilio, OpenAI-compatible API, Vola.ro API (reverse-engineered)

Experience

AdSymphony

Social Media Marketing Assistant

Bucharest

Oct 2022 – Nov 2022

- Designed UX/UI prototypes for client websites using Figma, improving layout clarity and user flows.
- Created motion graphics and animated social media content in Adobe After Effects, boosting campaign engagement.
- Managed design file libraries and iterated on deliverables based on real-time client feedback.

Emblema

Retail Sales Assistant

Bucharest

Jun 2022 – Aug 2022

- Assisted customers with product selection and maintained a well-organised store floor, contributing to a positive shopping experience.

Activities & Competitions

SCOALA-AMBASADOR – EU Programme

Volunteer Ambassador

Bucharest

Mar – May 2022

Organised school activities supporting the EU School Ambassador initiative, promoting European values and civic engagement.

Erasmus+ IDEAS Project

Digital Skills Trainer

Bucharest

Oct 2022

Welcomed and mentored visiting teachers and students from EU partner countries, delivering hands-on digital skills workshops.

ASUS Learn & Compete 2023

Competitor

Bucharest

Apr 2023

Competed in a national IT knowledge competition, demonstrating proficiency in computer science topics.

Volunteer Work

Neghiță Children's Centre

Volunteer

Bucharest

Sep 2021 – May 2024

Supported activities for underprivileged children over three years, demonstrating sustained commitment, empathy, and social responsibility.

Languages

Romanian (Native) English (Professional – B2/C1) French (B1)